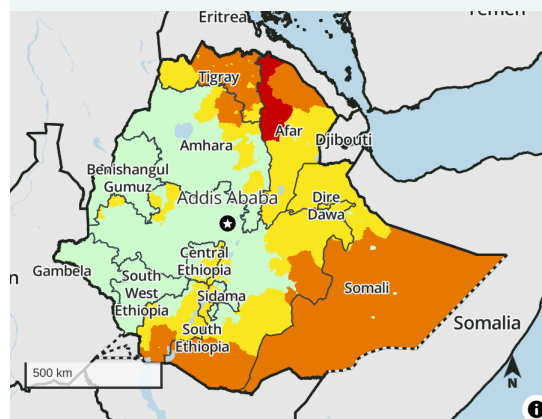


Crisis or worse outcomes persist amid slow recovery from past shocks

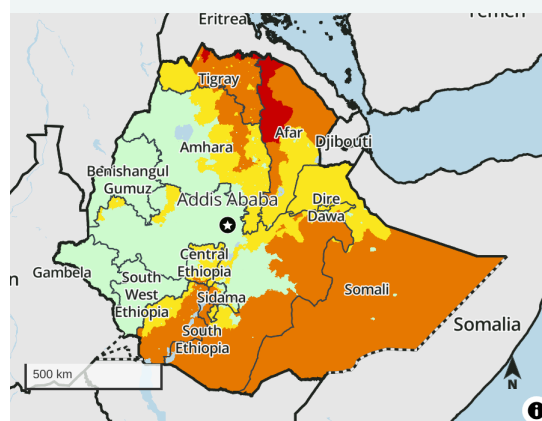
Key Messages

- Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes persist in areas of Ethiopia that are either currently affected by or recovering from conflict and drought. The *meher* harvest is only partially mitigating the size of household food consumption gaps or the use of negative coping strategies, as other key sources of food and income, such as livestock and agricultural labor, remain below normal. Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are likely currently ongoing in parts of Afar (Zones 2 and 4) and expected to spread to remote areas of Tigray by early 2025. Poor and displaced households in these areas face the largest constraints in terms of own-produced food stocks and livestock holdings, and the degree to which gifts and bartering through social networks, income from migratory labor, and wild foods can meet their food needs is limited.
- In the pastoral south and southeast, where livestock herd sizes have not recovered from the historic 2020-2023 drought, inadequate rainfall and atypical heat in late 2024 and early 2025 are expected to adversely affect livestock health, saleability, and milk production. Cumulative rainfall during the October to December *deyr/hageya* season ranges from **average to below average**, with deficits of 10-65 percent concentrated in the southern border areas of Somali and Oromia regions. Deficits in pasture and water availability are expected to worsen and spread during the January to mid-March *jilaal* dry season. Additionally, forecasts suggest the March to May *gu/genna* rains will most likely be below average. Area-level Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are currently anticipated through May, with pockets of the population likely to face Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes. However, if the *gu/genna* rains fail in the areas that were also affected by severe deficits during the *deyr/hageya* season, then livestock productivity would likely rapidly deteriorate during the subsequent mid-2025 dry season. In this scenario, more severe acute food insecurity outcomes would be anticipated in mid-2025.
- Conflict continues to contribute to acute food insecurity in Amhara and, to a lesser degree, Oromia regions by displacing civilians and disrupting humanitarian operations and essential services. Conflict in Amhara between the Ethiopian National Defense Force (ENDF) and the Fano militia has persisted through late 2024, concentrated in West Gojjam, North Shewa, East Gojjam, and North Wello zones. **ACLED**'s reporting on violent events suggest at least a 35 percent increase in frequency from September to October, followed by a 10 percent increase from October to November. In December, armed clashes have resulted in multiple road closures that impede civilian movement

Projected food security outcomes, December 2024 - January 2025



Projected food security outcomes, February - May 2025



IPC 3.1 Acute food insecurity classification

Sub-national level data

1: Minimal	3: Crisis	5: Famine
2: Stressed	4: Emergency	

Symbols

! Would likely be at least one phase worse without current or planned humanitarian food assistance

Mapped boundaries do not imply official recognition or endorsement of any physical or political boundaries.

FEWS NET classification is IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners. For full disclosure, see endnotes.

Source: FEWS NET

and daily activities, including both the flow of goods from source markets to larger markets, which results in temporary supply disruptions, and the ability to purchase goods for consumption. For example, on December 9, Fano militias announced road closures in East and West Gojjam, North Wello, and South Wello zones (**ACLED**), and in mid-December, the Addis Ababa-Dessie road in Shewa Zone was reportedly closed for two days.

- The *meher* harvest is now near complete, with near-average production countrywide. However, moderate production losses occurred in some areas of Amhara and Tigray regions due to late unseasonal rainfall in October and crop pests and diseases that damaged yields. According to **OCHA**, moisture-related losses in Tigray occurred in the Central, Eastern, and Northwestern zones. Additionally, in Central Ethiopia Region, unseasonal heavy rains during the first week of November caused flooding in Shashego *woreda* of Hadiya Zone, causing damage to some crops before they could be harvested. Conversely, in Oromia, the regional Agriculture Cluster reported significant crop losses in areas of Borena, East Borena, and West Guji zones due to long dry spells.
- **According to the Food Cluster**, humanitarians reached around 1.2 million people in November. This is the lowest level of assistance delivered in 2024 (a decline of nearly 45 percent month-on-month, compared to around 2.1 million people reached in October). Food assistance distributions typically decline late in the year as households access food from own production and income from crop sales and agricultural labor; however, areas recovering from the impacts of conflict and drought continue to require humanitarian assistance. Accordingly, food aid deliveries are currently concentrated in Tigray, Oromia, Somali, and Amhara regions. According to **ECHO**, drought and conflict affected 77,000 people in Bugna and Lasta districts in North Wollo (Amhara Region). **Food aid deliveries** resumed in these districts following a short suspension due to security concerns. Prior to the resumption of assistance, anecdotal reports indicated severe food shortages among the population. Limited resources, along with access and security challenges in contested areas of Tigray, Somali, Amhara, and Oromia regions, impeded humanitarians reaching the planned number of beneficiaries.

Recommended citation: FEWS NET. Ethiopia Key Message Update December 2024: Crisis or worse outcomes persist amid slow recovery from past shocks, 2024.

* FEWS NET's classifications are IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners. As of IPC 3.0, the IPC no longer assesses the impact of food assistance on classification and thus no longer maps the (!). However, FEWS NET continues to produce food security maps inclusive of the (!) as well as maps compatible with IPC 3.0/3.1, which include the mapping of food security assistance bags. FEWS NET and the IPC use different methods to estimate the total Population in Need of humanitarian food assistance and assess the risk of Famine. Learn more at www.fews.net/about.

Key Message Update

This Key Message Update provides a high-level analysis of current acute food insecurity conditions and any changes to FEWS NET's latest projection of acute food insecurity outcomes in the specified geography. Learn more [here](#).